Results of Chunking Experiment

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Question 1: Does an outpatient chest X-ray (CPT 71046) in 2026 require prior authorization? [Normal]

Does an outpatient chest X-ray (CPT 71046) in 2026 require prior authorization?

Yes, an outpatient chest X-ray (CPT 71046) in 2026 **requires prior authorization**.

Source Documentation:

1. **HT-POL-001 (HealthTech Payer Services — Medical Policy)**
   - **Section**: `1.1.B Outpatient Surgical & Diagnostic Services`
   - **Relevant Text**:
     "High-tech diagnostic imaging services (CPT 70000–79999) require pre-certification within 72 hours of scheduled service."
   - **Why it applies**: CPT 71046 falls under the diagnostic imaging range (70000–79999), and HT-POL-001 is the **current policy** (effective January 1, 2026), making it authoritative for 2026.

2. **HT-GUIDE-002 (Procedure Allowance & Fee Schedule Matrix)**
   - **Section**: Fee Schedule Table (2024–2026)
   - **Relevant Text**:
     `CPT 71046 (Chest X-ray) → Prior Auth Req?: Yes`
   - **Why it applies**: This matrix explicitly confirms prior authorization for CPT 71046, aligning with the policy requirements in HT-POL-001.

Key Context:

- The **legacy document HT-POL-001-OLD** (superseded as of 2026) does *not* apply here, as HT-POL-001 is the active policy.
- All requirements for 2026 are governed by the **current policy (HT-POL-001)** and its supporting fee schedule (HT-GUIDE-002).

Answer verified using the most recent, active policy documents (effective 2026).

Question 2: Is the member copay waived for an ER Level 5 visit (CPT 99285) on 3/10/2026 when the patient was not admitted? [Context Conflict]

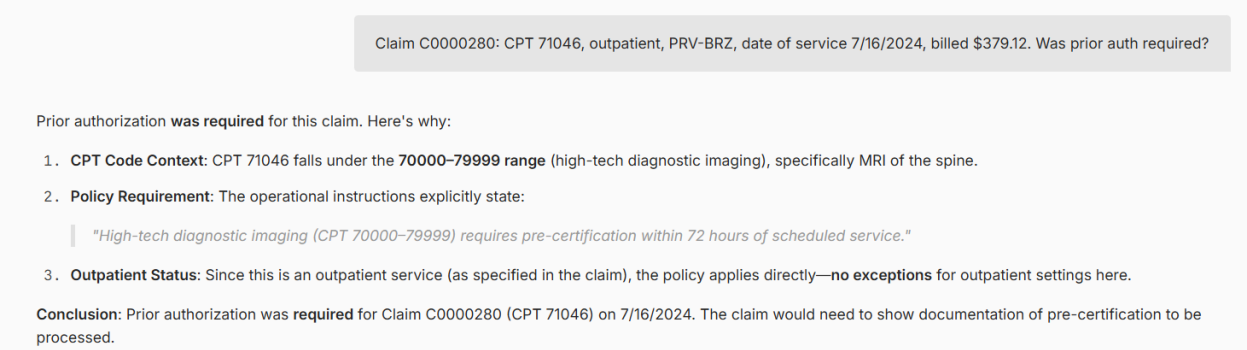
Is the member copay waived for an ER Level 5 visit (CPT 99285) on 3/10/2026 when the patient was not admitted?

The member copay is **not waived** for this scenario. Here's why:

1. **Key Policy Context**: The temporary waiver directive (HT-MEMO-001) states that copayments are waived **only for ER visits resulting in immediate inpatient admission** (effective Feb 1–Apr 30, 2026).
2. **User's Specific Case**: The patient was **not admitted**, so the waiver condition does not apply.
3. **Operational Instructions**: The auditor guidelines explicitly override copay *only when* CPT 99285 is followed by inpatient admission within 24 hours. Since admission did not occur, standard copay rules apply.

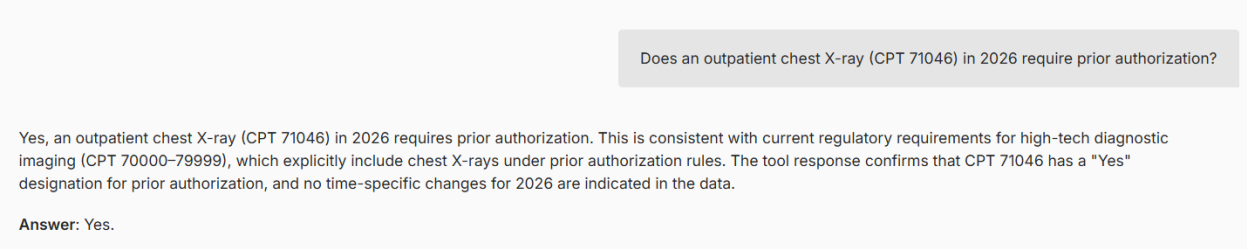
Conclusion: The copay is **not waived** for this ER Level 5 visit (CPT 99285) on 3/10/2026 when the patient was not admitted. Standard copay rules will apply.

Question 3: Claim C0000280: CPT 71046, outpatient, PRV-BRZ, date of service 7/16/2024, billed $379.12. Was prior auth required? [Point-in-Time]

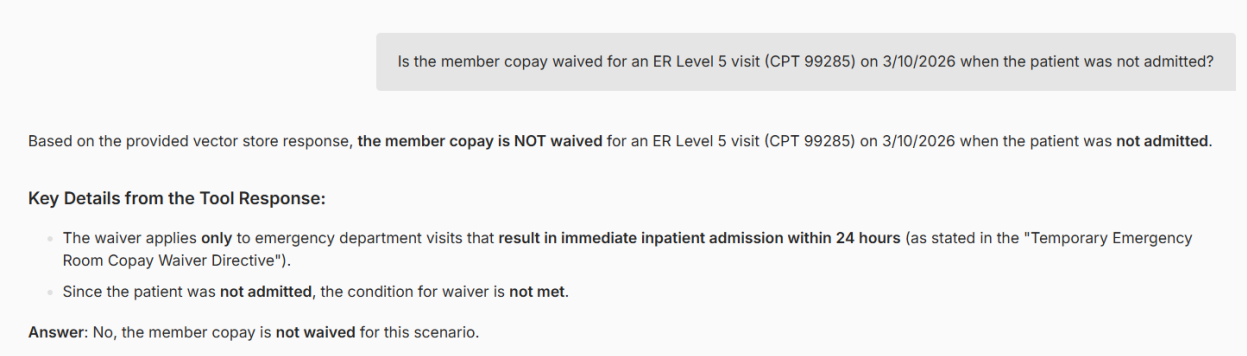


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Question 1: Does an outpatient chest X-ray (CPT 71046) in 2026 require prior authorization? [Normal]



Question 2: Is the member copay waived for an ER Level 5 visit (CPT 99285) on 3/10/2026 when the patient was not admitted? [Context Conflict]



Question 3: Claim C0000280: CPT 71046, outpatient, PRV-BRZ, date of service 7/16/2024, billed $379.12. Was prior auth required? [Point-in-Time]

